in the same capacity. By now he had earned an enviable reputation for efficiency, integrity, and professionalism.

When the Hyderabad Circle was carved out of the Madras Circle in 1965, Talwar became the first Secretary and Treasurer of the Hyderabad Circle and was entrusted with the task of setting up the new Circle office. According to N. Vaghul, who was his private secretary when Talwar was Chairman and went on to become Chairman of ICICI, the manner in which he went about creating the new Circle office and the standards and benchmarks he established for performance are still talked about with awe and esteem by colleagues who worked with him during that period.[5] In January 1966, Talwar was appointed as Secretary and Treasurer of the Bombay Circle. On February 1, 1968, when he was appointed as one of the two Managing Directors of the State Bank, he became the youngest to grace that office. His dizzying rise reached its acme when on March 1, 1969, he became the Chairman of SBI, the first professional banker from within the ranks of the SBI to occupy this position, and at 47, by far the youngest.

More than his achievements, Talwar's honesty and integrity drew universal admiration. Both the government and the RBI listened with respect to his views and he was generally recognized as the spokesperson for the industry. He was appointed initially for five years and his term was extended by another three years in 1974. Unfortunately, his second tenure was cut short when he refused to oblige Sanjay Gandhi, and he was eased out prematurely in August 1976 before the expiry of his second term. D.N. Ghosh, who was with the Ministry of Finance and became the Chairman of SBI in 1985, observed that Talwar grew taller on the day he resigned. 'This to my mind was his finest hour.'[6]

Talwar was a deeply spiritual person with an unshakeable belief in the divine. He was a devotee of Aurobindo and the Mother of Pondicherry and made frequent visits to the Ashram there. The loss of the Chairmanship made little difference to him since he sincerely believed that he was nothing but an instrument of the divine and everything that happened was due to the divine will. N. Vaghul recalls that he had never come across a person who had such an unwavering faith in divinity. While many of Talwar's friends and admirers were vocal about his removal, Talwar never, ever, by word or gesture referred to it. In this, as in many other matters, he displayed an inner calm which was the result of his deep spirituality. Talwar retired to